

Meridian State University

Examination and Grading Policy

Grading Scale, Academic Standing, and Grade Appeal Procedures

Document Code: REG-POL-204

Effective Date: August 1, 2026

Issuing Office: Office of the Registrar & Academic Affairs

Review Cycle: Annual

1. Purpose and Applicability

This policy establishes uniform standards for the administration of examinations and the assignment of academic grades across all colleges and schools of Meridian State University. It applies to all credit-bearing courses, including in-person, hybrid, and fully online offerings.

2. Grading Scale

Final course grades are recorded on a letter-grade scale, each associated with a grade-point value used to compute the cumulative and term grade point averages (GPA).

Letter Grade	GPA Value	Percentage Range	Description
A	4.0	93–100	Excellent
A-	3.7	90–92	Excellent
B+	3.3	87–89	Good
B	3.0	83–86	Good
B-	2.7	80–82	Above Average
C+	2.3	77–79	Average
C	2.0	73–76	Average
C-	1.7	70–72	Below Average
D	1.0	60–69	Poor, Minimum Passing
F	0.0	Below 60	Failing
I	—	—	Incomplete
W	—	—	Withdrawn
P/NP	—	—	Pass / No Pass (approved courses only)

3. Examination Scheduling

Final examinations are scheduled centrally by the Registrar according to the published final exam matrix and must not be moved, combined, or administered early without written approval from the relevant Dean's office. Take-home or online proctored finals must be made available within the same 24-hour window designated for the course's exam slot unless an alternate arrangement has been approved.

- No more than two final examinations may be scheduled for a single student within a 24-hour period; conflicts must be reported to the Registrar within the first two weeks of the term.
- Make-up examinations require documented justification (medical, family emergency, religious observance, or University-sanctioned activity).

- Instructors must retain final examination materials for a minimum of one academic year.

4. Academic Standing and GPA Requirements

4.1 Good Academic Standing

Undergraduate students must maintain a cumulative GPA of 2.0 or higher; graduate students must maintain a cumulative GPA of 3.0 or higher, to remain in good academic standing.

4.2 Academic Probation and Suspension

Students falling below the minimum GPA threshold are placed on academic probation for one term. Failure to return to good standing, or to meet an individualized academic improvement plan, results in academic suspension for a minimum of two consecutive terms. Reinstatement following suspension requires a petition to the Academic Standards Committee.

5. Grade Appeals

A student who believes a final grade was assigned in error, or was based on factors other than the announced grading criteria, may initiate a grade appeal within 30 calendar days of grade posting. The appeal proceeds through three stages:

- Stage 1 — Informal resolution directly with the course instructor.
- Stage 2 — Formal written appeal to the department chair if informal resolution is unsuccessful.
- Stage 3 — Review by the College Grade Appeals Committee, whose decision is final.

Note: Grade appeals may not be used to contest the academic judgment underlying a grade, only procedural or factual errors in its calculation or application.

6. Incomplete Grades

An Incomplete (I) may be assigned only when a student has completed at least 75% of course requirements with a passing average but is unable to finish due to circumstances beyond their control. An Incomplete Grade Contract must be signed by the instructor and student, specifying the outstanding work and a completion deadline no later than the end of the following term. An unresolved Incomplete automatically converts to an F.

7. Academic Honesty in Examinations

All examinations are subject to the University's Academic Integrity Policy. Suspected violations observed during an examination, including unauthorized materials, impersonation, or collusion, must be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity within five business days.

8. Frequently Asked Questions

How is the term GPA different from the cumulative GPA?

The term GPA reflects only courses completed in a single academic term, while the cumulative GPA reflects all coursework counted toward the degree, including repeated courses under the University's Grade Replacement policy.

Can I request a regrade of a final exam?

Regrade requests for a final exam must be submitted in writing to the instructor within 10 business days of grade posting and are limited to demonstrable errors in scoring or point totals, not to a general re-evaluation of academic judgment.

Does withdrawing from a course affect my GPA?

A grade of W does not carry grade-point value and therefore does not affect the GPA, though it does count toward attempted credit hours for Satisfactory Academic Progress purposes.

9. Related Policies and Resources

This policy should be read in conjunction with other governing University policies, including the University Catalog, the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) Notice, and any college- or department-specific handbooks that supplement, but do not contradict, the standards set out here. Where a conflict exists between this policy and a college-level document, this policy governs unless an explicit written exception has been approved by the Provost's Office.

- University Catalog (undergraduate and graduate editions), published annually
- FERPA Notice of Student Rights, available through the Office of the Registrar
- Student Handbook, distributed at orientation and available online
- College- and department-specific supplemental guidelines, where applicable

10. Contact and Further Assistance

Questions regarding the interpretation or application of this policy should be directed to the Office of the Registrar. Students are encouraged to reach out early in the process, as many concerns can be resolved informally before they require a formal procedure.

Contact Point	Detail
Office	Office of the Registrar
Email	registrar@meridianstate.edu
Phone	(555) 201-4410
Office Hours	Monday–Friday, 8:30 a.m. – 5:00 p.m.
Walk-in Location	Student Services Building, Suite 200

11. Policy Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Changes
1.0	August 2021	Initial policy adopted by the Board of Trustees.
1.1	August 2023	Clarified procedural timelines and appeal deadlines.
2.0	August 2025	Comprehensive revision to align with updated accreditation standards.
2.1	August 2026	Minor updates for the current academic year; see effective date above.

Note: This document supersedes all prior versions upon its effective date. Archived versions are available upon request from the issuing office.